RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 2:50 AM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 95 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 31 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 11,670 minutes at 12:00 AM (no movements since the 8:43 PM non-scheduled landing); Dammam moving, no open halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 11,670 minutes at 12:00 AM; no takeoffs or landings since the 9 PM edition (last movement a non-scheduled landing, N437GA from Athens at 8:43 PM)**.
- Riyadh ended Monday with 171 flights cancelled (29%); 95 Tuesday flights already cancelled (16%), and the NOTAM still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- Coalition warns the Houthis against smuggling weapons by sea and releases strike footage; Saudi, UAE and Turkish foreign ministers condemn the continued attacks.
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 10:21 AM Monday: 8 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9 PM, latest XY408 from Jeddah at 11:49 PM; Tasnim report of a drone attack halting Dammam is unconfirmed.
- FII10 investor conference in Riyadh officially postponed to 2027 (SPA, 10:49 PM).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (11841 min).

95	0/0	2
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

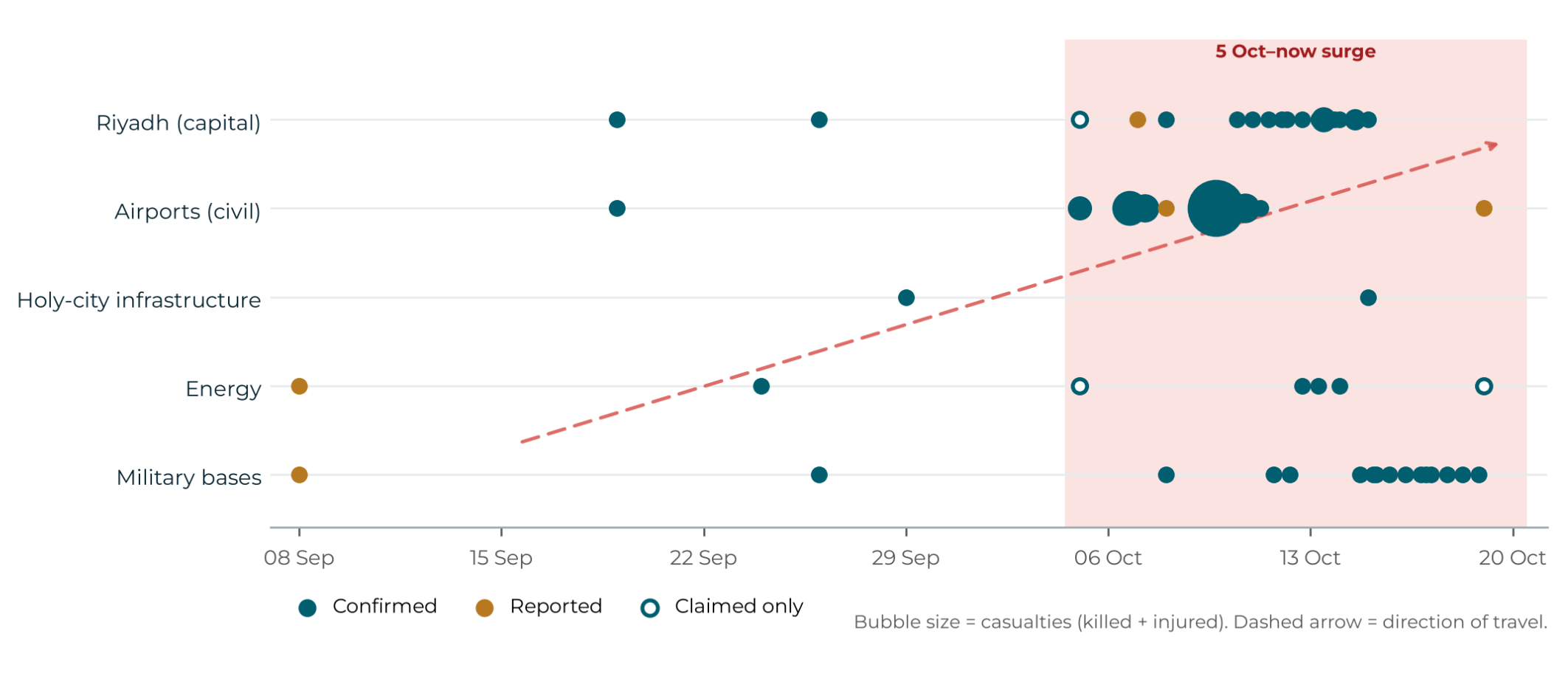
No takeoff or landing since 2:04 AM (46 min).

31	0/1	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (11,490 min at 9:00 PM); since 6 PM no takeoffs and one non-scheduled landing, N437GA from Athens at 8:43 PM
- FII Institute postpones the FII10 conference in Riyadh (26 to 29 Oct) to 2027 (6:14 PM)
- Houthi spokesman claims six strikes in 48 hours on Yanbu, Shaybah, Riyadh and Abha airports and Khamis Mushait (7:41 PM); not confirmed by Saudi authorities
- No new Civil Defense alert, interception, debris or casualty report in Saudi Arabia since 6:00 PM
- Dammam since 6 PM: 12 takeoffs (latest RJ741 to Amman 8:46 PM) and 13 landings (latest SV1124 from Jeddah 8:45 PM), no halt

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



52 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Tasnim reports a Houthi drone attack on Dammam halting airport activity; no Saudi confirmation, and the Dammam board shows only a 35-minute gap (9:12 to 9:47 PM) (19 Oct, Tasnim via FinancialJuice / CGTN; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 12:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 12:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, alerts 4, all-clears 4.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh still halted with prior-permission NOTAM; quiet night with no new Saudi alert or attack; US Mission repeats airport-use restriction

Checked at 2:50 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: OIC creates a council of cybersecurity ministers, headquartered in Riyadh, on a Saudi proposal**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:40 AM** · published 1:40 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 2:50 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya reported that, on a proposal from the Kingdom, the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation is creating a council of cybersecurity ministers based in Riyadh.

CONFIRMED **US State Department: US government staff need special authorization to use any Saudi airport**

US State Dept travel (@TravelGov); US Mission Saudi Arabia (@USAinKSA) · **11:17 PM** · published 11:17 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); repeated as a US Mission security alert at 12:40 AM Tue 20 Oct; checked 2:50 AM

The State Department reminded US citizens in Saudi Arabia to follow the national alerts Saudi Civil Defense sends by cellular broadcast. It said US government employees working in the Kingdom need special authorization from the Chief of Mission to use any airport in Saudi Arabia. The US Mission in Saudi Arabia reissued the same guidance as a formal security alert at 12:40 AM.

CONFIRMED **FII Institute postpones the FII10 investor conference in Riyadh to 2027**

SPA (@Spa_Eng); FII Institute; CNBC, The National · **10:49 PM** · SPA published 10:49 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); FII Institute statement and CNBC first at 6:14 PM AST; checked 11:58 PM

Saudi Press Agency confirmed at 10:49 PM that the FII Institute has postponed FII10, due 26 to 29 October at the King Abdulaziz International Conference Center in Riyadh, to 2027, with new dates to come and registrations still valid. The statement does not cite security, but CNBC, The National, WSJ and FT link the decision to the escalating Houthi missile and drone attacks, including the 10 October strike on Riyadh airport.

CONFIRMED **Coalition warns Houthis against smuggling weapons by sea in traditional boats and releases strike footage**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA; Al Ekhbariya · **10:48 PM** · Al Ekhbariya first at 9:45 PM AST; SPA story and Coalition footage 10:48 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official accounts, Arabic translated); checked 11:58 PM

The Coalition Joint Forces Command warned the Houthi militia against using traditional maritime vessels to smuggle weapons, missiles and military equipment, saying it threatens Yemeni, regional and international security and endangers civilians, and urged boat owners not to deal with the militia. It then published footage of tracking and striking smuggled weapons and vessels it says organised-crime groups used to move arms to the Yemeni coast for the Houthis.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Foreign Minister and UAE and Turkish counterparts condemn continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**

SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions); Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **10:10 PM** · SPA Arabic 8:39 and 8:48 PM; SPA English 9:19 PM (Turkey) and 10:10 PM (UAE); MOFA posts 11:14 and 11:17 PM AST Mon 19 Oct; checked 11:58 PM

Prince Faisal bin Farhan took calls from UAE Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed and Turkish Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan. SPA says both calls condemned the Houthi militia's continued attacks on Saudi Arabia, and the Saudi and UAE ministers agreed to step up coordination.

UNVERIFIED **Tasnim: Houthi drone attack on Dammam halted the airport; Dammam board shows traffic continued**

Tasnim (Iran), relayed by FinancialJuice and CGTN · **9:33 PM** · first relayed 9:33 PM AST Mon 19 Oct; CGTN 9:38 PM; no Saudi confirmation; board checked 11:51 PM

Iran's Tasnim news agency reported a Yemeni drone attack on Dammam and said airport activity was halted. Saudi authorities have reported no attack or interception in the Eastern Region tonight, and the Flightradar24 board shows only a 35-minute gap at Dammam (9:12 to 9:47 PM) followed by normal takeoffs and landings, so no halt is recorded.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official airspace updates and check with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **9:11 PM** · published 9:11 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account, reply in Arabic, translated); repeated in a reply at 12:07 AM Tue 20 Oct; checked 2:50 AM

Replying to passengers on X at 9:11 PM and again at 12:07 AM, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates travellers should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening date.

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman claims six strikes on Saudi oil sites, airports and bases in 48 hours**

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree via Saba · **7:41 PM** · statement dated 19 Oct; first seen 7:41 PM AST; TASS 8:25 PM AST; checked 8:58 PM

Saree claims ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and drones hit Aramco in Yanbu and the Shaybah oil field (causing fires), Riyadh airport, Abha airport, Khamis Mushait air base, radars and a naval camp. Saudi authorities have not confirmed any of these hits; the coalition earlier reported intercepting a Yanbu-bound missile and drones over the Riyadh and southern regions.

CONFIRMED **Qatar Airways extends Riyadh and Dammam suspension to 24 October and cuts Jeddah to four daily flights**

QNA (Qatar News Agency) · **4:13 PM** · published 4:13 PM AST Mon 19 Oct; checked 11:58 PM

Qatar Airways said its suspension of flights to and from Riyadh and Dammam stays in place until 24 October, while Jeddah services drop from seven to four daily flights. Passengers are asked to contact the airline within 48 hours of departure.

CORROBORATED **Bloomberg: GACA and airport officials say Riyadh stays shut to regular flights with no reopening timeline**

Bloomberg; Business Today · **3:15 PM** · Bloomberg published 12:15 UTC (3:15 PM AST) Mon 19 Oct; matches NOTAM A3650/26 and A3651/26; checked 11:58 PM

Bloomberg reports officials at GACA and King Khalid International Airport confirmed the airport remained shut to regular flights on Monday with no clear reopening timeline. NOTAM A3650/26 requires prior GACA permission for every arrival and departure, and A3651/26 bars Riyadh as a diversion airport; both are open-ended.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Riyadh City, then all-clear (danger passed)**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **4:58 PM** · published 4:58–5:07 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM

National Early Warning Platform alert for Riyadh City at 4:58 PM AST; all-clear at 5:07 PM. Civil Defense also warned against filming or sharing information on missile/drone interceptions and impact sites.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Al-Kharj Governorate, then all-clear (danger passed)**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **4:59 PM** · published 4:59–5:08 PM AST Mon 19 Oct (official account); checked 6:04 PM

National Early Warning Platform alert for Al-Kharj Governorate at 4:59 PM AST; all-clear at 5:08 PM. No MoD/Coalition intercept statement published for this window as of check.

CORROBORATED **The National: many airlines keep Saudi suspensions in place, some into November and 2027**

The National · Mon 19 Oct · **Mon 19 Oct** · published Mon 19 Oct (time not shown); matches DPA; checked 2:52 PM AST

Etihad, flydubai and Qatar Airways have cancelled Riyadh and Dammam flights up to and including 24 Oct, Oman Air has suspended Riyadh until 22 Oct, and SalamAir has cancelled Riyadh and Dammam until 31 Oct. British Airways plans a limited daily Riyadh service from 3 Nov, and Cathay Pacific has extended its Riyadh suspension to 31 Jan 2027.

UNVERIFIED **AP: Saudi Arabia opens a probe into its air-defence failure at Riyadh airport on 10 Oct**

AP · Mon 19 Oct · **Mon 19 Oct** · published Mon 19 Oct (time not shown); two unnamed regional officials; checked 2:52 PM AST

AP reports, citing two regional officials, that Saudi Arabia is investigating how its air defences failed to intercept the missile and drone barrage that included the airport attack that killed at least 13 people and wounded more than 300. There is no official Saudi statement on the probe.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (11841 min).

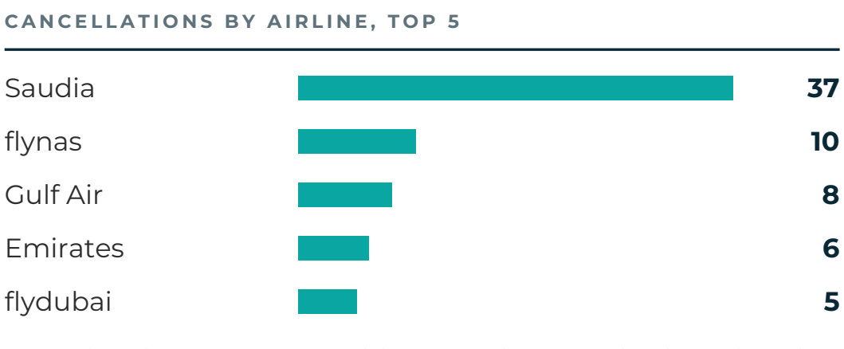
95	—	8:43 PM	0	2
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
43 departures + 52 arrivals, 16% of 592 scheduled.	None on the board.	N437GA from Athens, 367 min before 2:50 AM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam, Jeddah.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:50 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 93 at 2:50 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

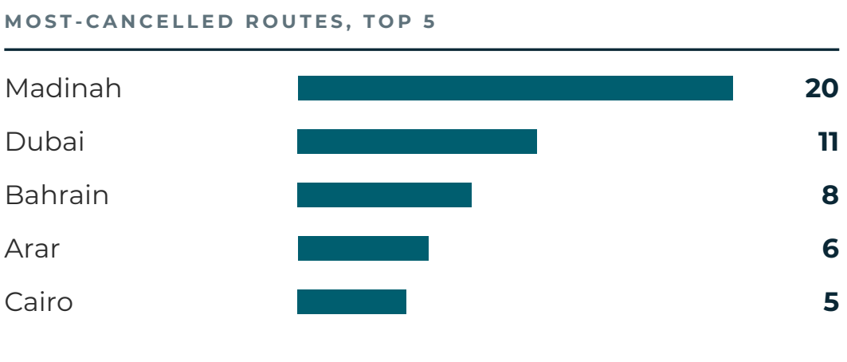
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	43	52	95	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	43 (14%)	50 (17%)	93	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	1 (100%)	1 (100%)	2	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 23	0 of 34	0 of 57	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	2	2	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	9	12	21	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	72	100	172	FR24 stats panel

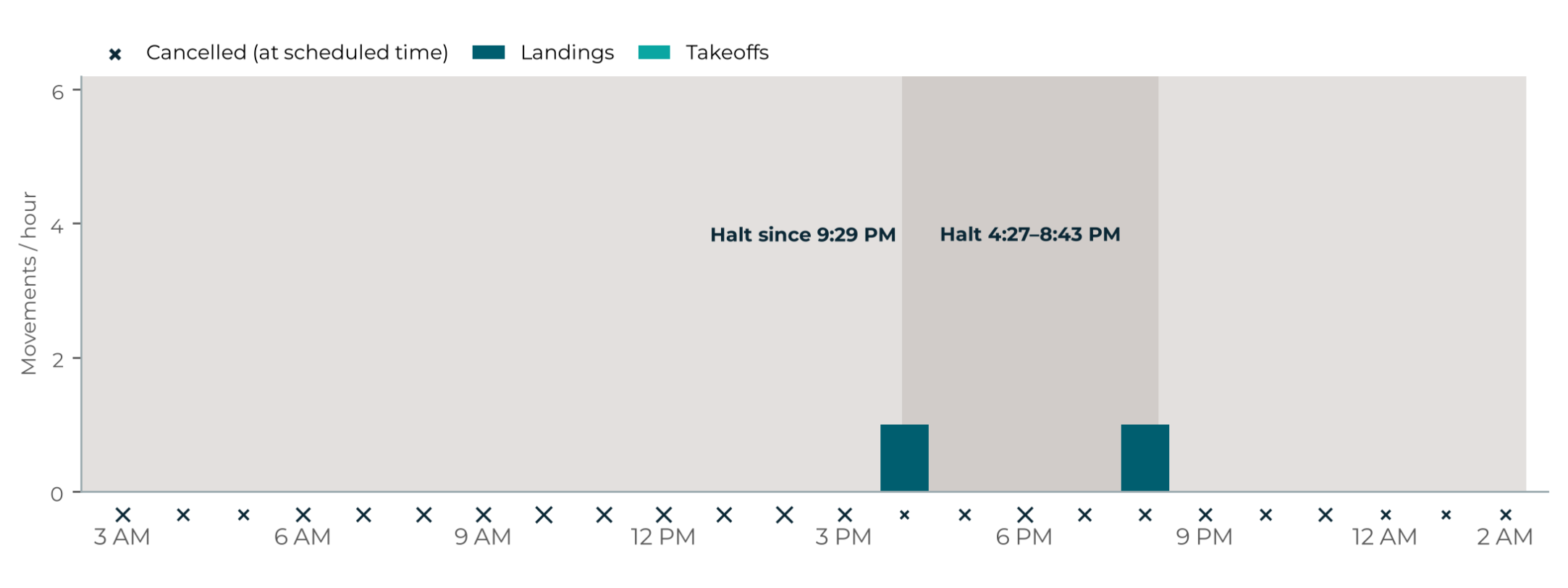
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



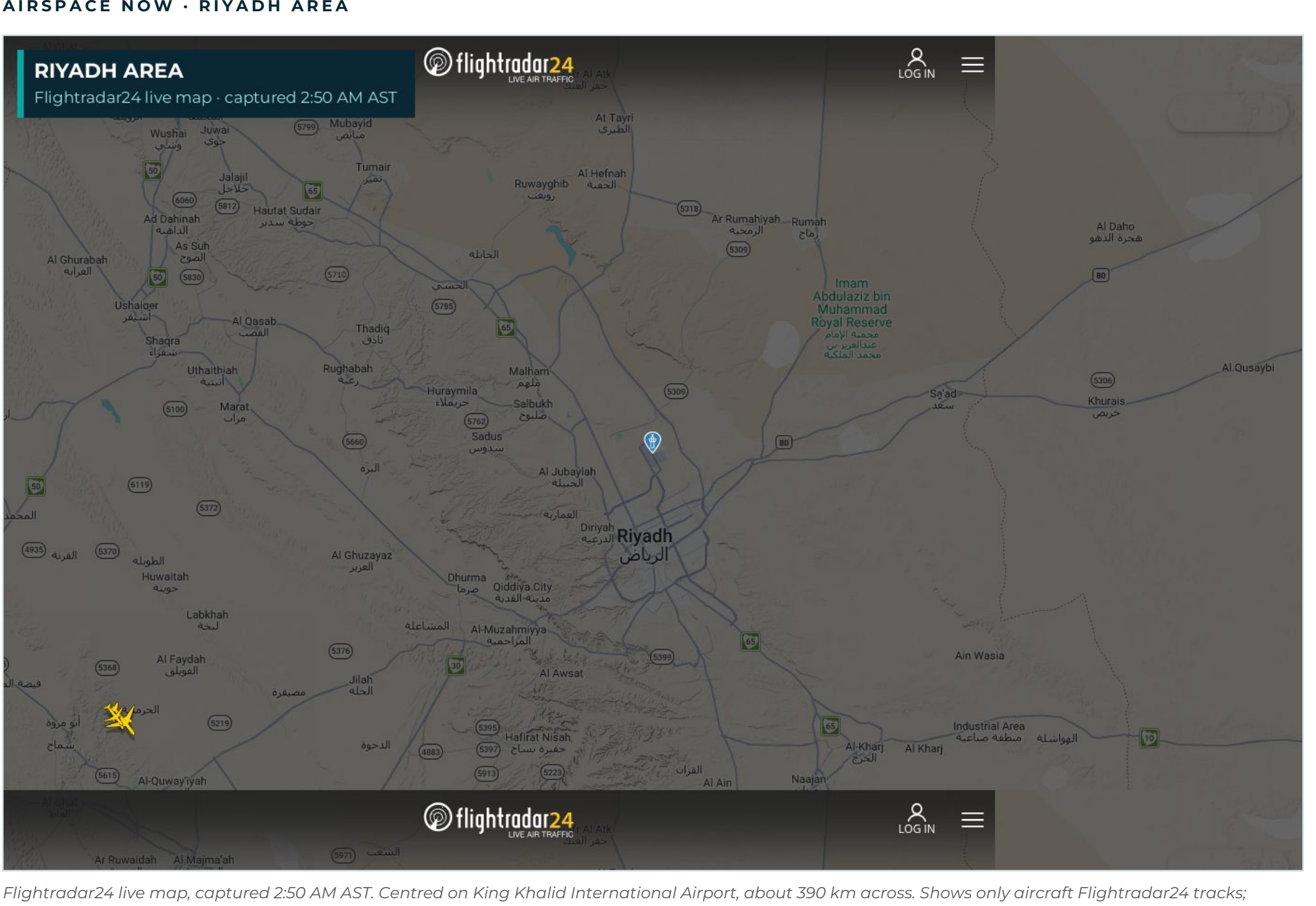
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 3:00 AM Monday to 2:50 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are two non-scheduled landings, SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 1:02–2:24 AM, 8:24–9:17 AM and 9:32–10:21 AM Monday; traffic has kept moving since, with a 35-minute gap from 9:12 to 9:47 PM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 4:27–8:43 PM	256 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	11841 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:50 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. No takeoff or landing since 2:04 AM (46 min).

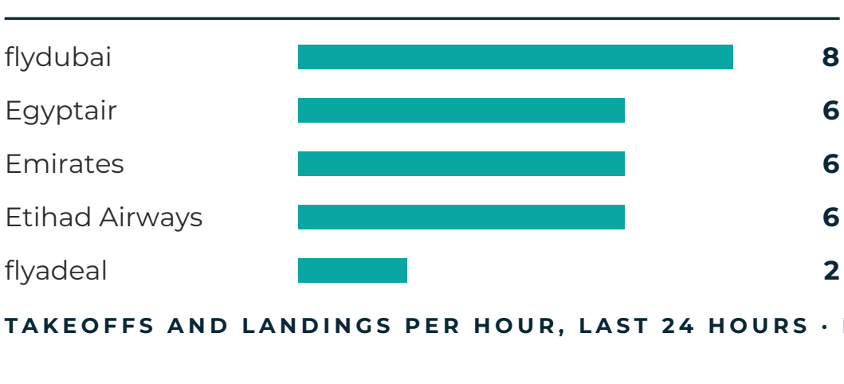
31	1:48 AM	2:04 AM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
16 departures + 15 arrivals, 14% of 220 scheduled.	XY407 to Jeddah, 62 min before 2:50 AM.	F3466 from Madinah, 46 min before 2:50 AM.	1 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 2:50 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 31 at 2:50 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

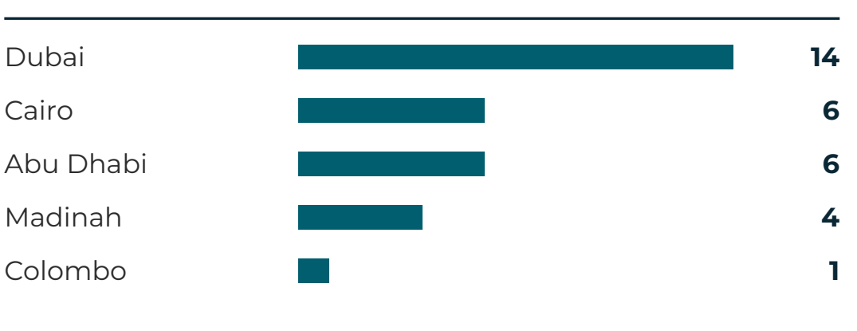
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	16	15	31	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	16 (14%)	15 (14%)	31	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	5 (4%)	2 (2%)	7	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	2 (29%)	2 (50%)	4	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	12 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	4 of 8	2 of 10	6 of 18	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	3	6	9	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	18	33	FR24 stats panel

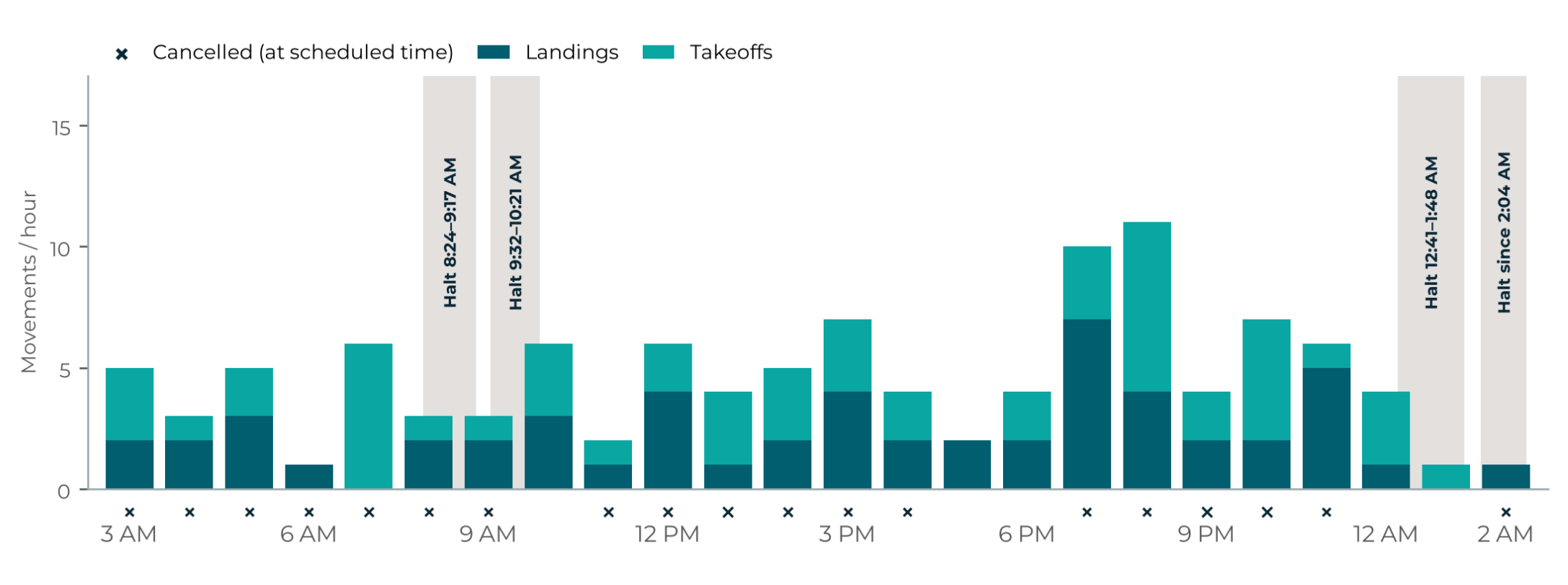
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (55) and landings (55) at DMM per hour from 3:00 AM Monday to 2:50 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 1 takeoff and 5 landings in the last hour; no halt since 10:21 AM Monday (halts Monday morning 8:24 to 9:17 AM and 9:32 to 10:21 AM).

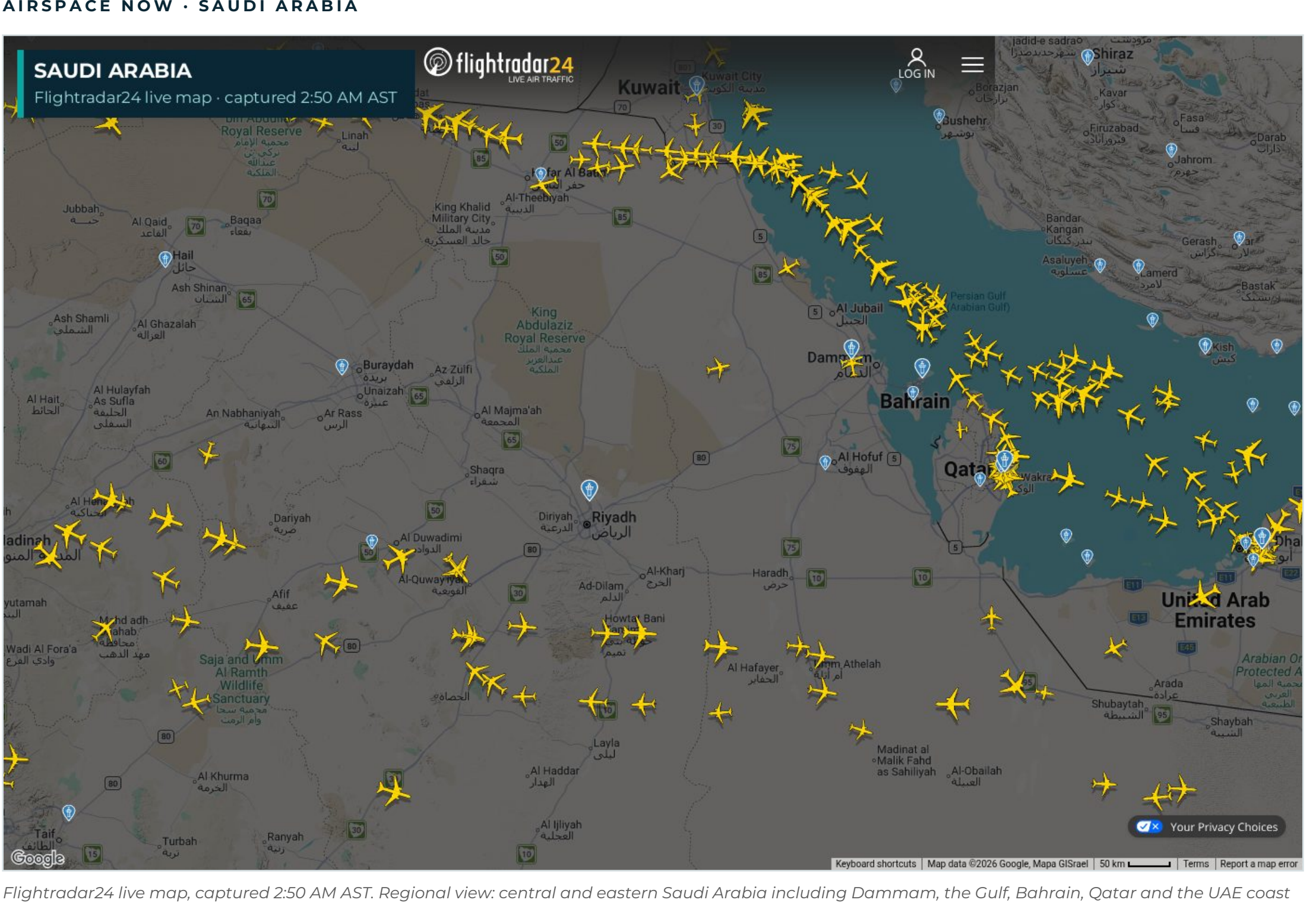
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 2:04 AM	46 min and counting
Halt 12:41–1:48 AM	66 min
Halt 9:32–10:21 AM	49 min
Halt 8:24–9:17 AM	53 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (2:50 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



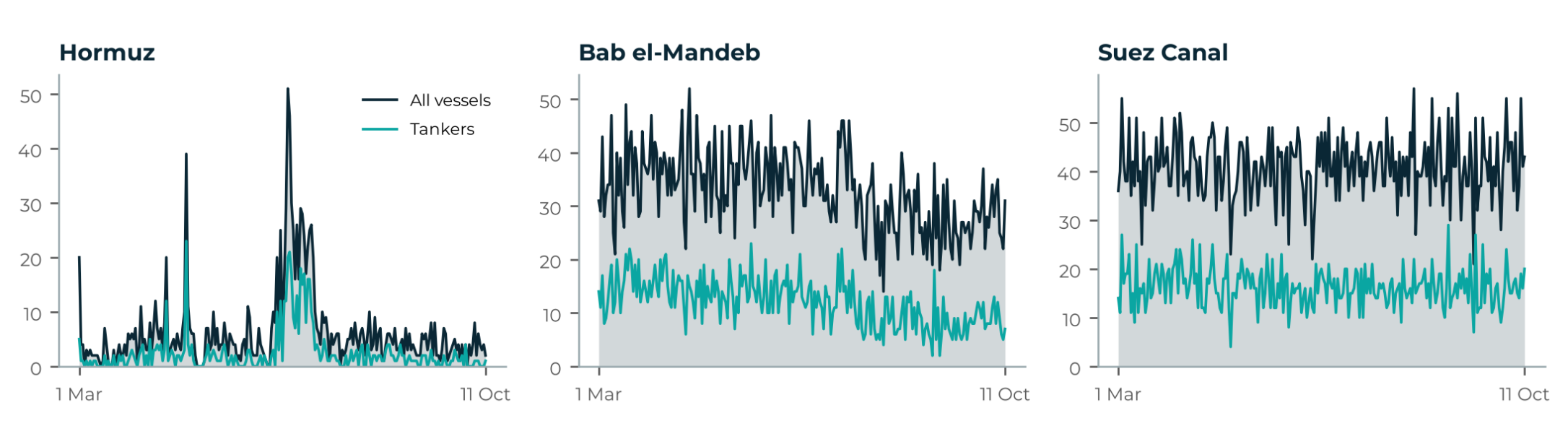
Flightradar24 live map, captured 2:50 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

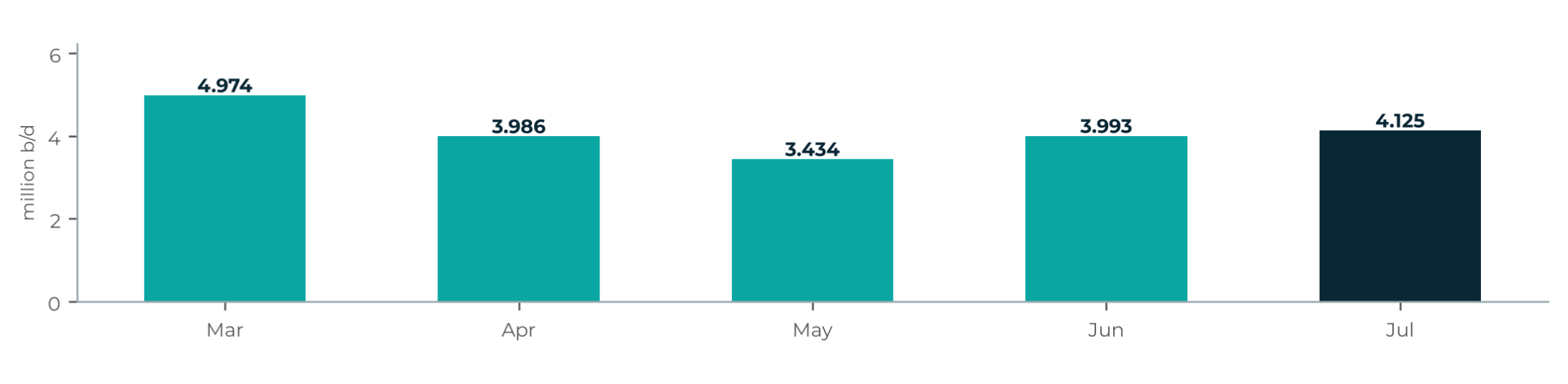
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 2:51 AM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

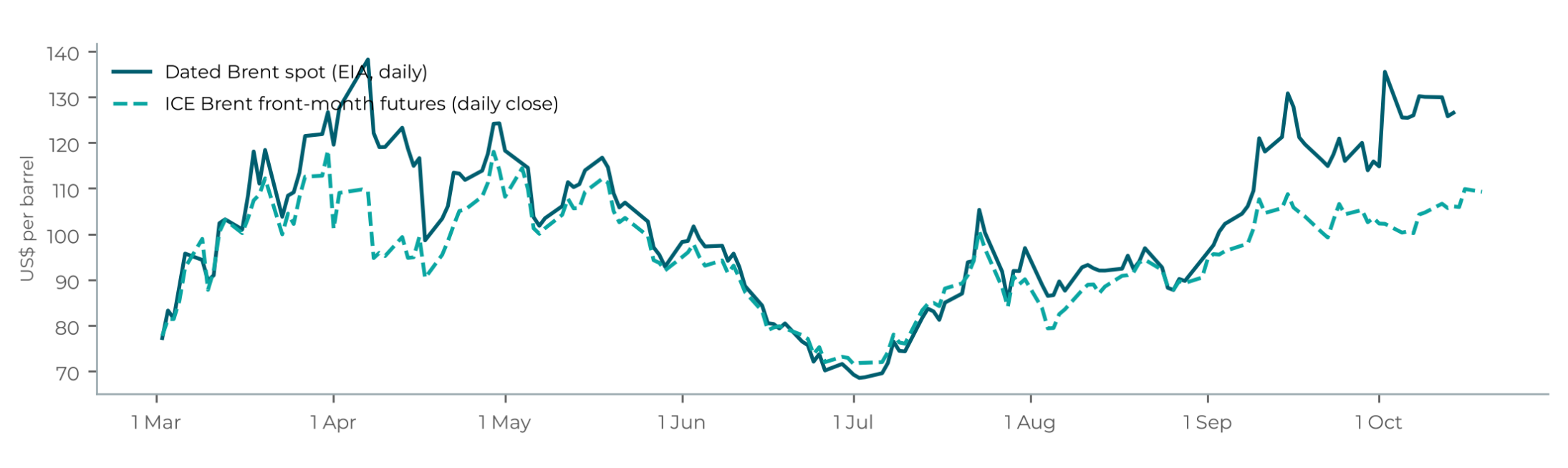


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.25	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 2:27 AM, Tue 20 Oct AST (-0.3% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 2:50 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
2:50 AM, Tue 20 Oct	2:50 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	3:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 AM